Design justifications for design C:

1. Addressing the client statement and problem:

"I see there are a lot of website out there that does the same thing as ours, but theirs are just so… bland. I need ours to pop! Whether it's them checking out a course, pushing a button, or finishing a course, something needs to stand out!"

Design solution: To solve the issue regarding bland interactions and to effectively use the peak-end rule, we've transformed standard button clicks and lesson completion screens into celebratory moments. Strumly implements the following:

- **Celebratory animations**: When interacting with primary buttons such as saving a course for later, a small confetti celebration is generated, and completing a lesson triggers a celebratory completion screen.

- **Rewarding milestone stats**: Instead of a generic success message, the completion screen validates the learner's hard work by summarising their achievements into colourful badges and showing how they're progressing.

- **Frictionless momentum**: All completion feedback is combined into a single container. By providing a clear "Next lesson" call-to-action button alongside a "Back to course" button, the interface keeps the user's positive emotional high without any navigation friction.

2. Theoretical application of the Peak-End rule

Conventional standards	**Strumly Implementation**
Standard/static button click states	Confetti animations triggered when interacting with import primary buttons like "Start course"
Bland "Lesson complete" text	Motivating "Lesson complete!" header alongside an animated guitar pick badge and confetti
Immediate redirection or empty screen after finishing	Specific rewards badges are displayed on the completion screen to maximize the psychological reward at the end of the lesson.
Forcing users to manually navigate to the next lesson/course	A clear, high contrast "Next lesson" button placed inside the celebration container guides the user forward, and the "Back to course" button gives them the freedom to move at their own pace.

3. Empirical justification from UEQ reports:

UEQ Evaluated Site	High-Scoring Criteria	Identified Issues	Strumly implementation and fix
Duolingo	Clear/focused layout with high contrast buttons and exciting/interesting execution of peak-end rule by using colourful stat badges and illustrations	Moderately obstructive “claim XP” button that forces users to interact with the reward system instead of letting them advance easily.	Adopted Duolingo’s exciting visual peak (confetti/badges/guitar pick) and colourful stat badges, but removed the obstructive reward interaction by prioritizing a clear “Next lesson” button instead
Chess.com	Clear, efficient and uncluttered layout with encouraging text and a frictionless “Next lesson” button	Doesn’t contain lesson specific performance metrics.	Adopted Chess.com’s frictionless “Next lesson” button and supportive text, but elevated the emotional peak by adding reward/stat badges directly onto the completion screen.
JustinGuitar	Relatively easy and straightforward basic visual confirmation after completing a	Obstructive and inefficient navigation (no clear CTA to advance, separated feedback areas, etc); Boring/static feedback that completely misses the peak-end rule.	Avoided JustinGuitar’s bland, static feedback by combining all completion info into a single container, adding exciting visual celebrations and motivational text, providing progress/reward stats, and ensuring a clear “Next lesson” CTA button to prevent navigation friction.

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